POLICY MAJOR

BECAUSE he continues to be PM Modi's most trusted lieutenant for designing and implementing big policies and social sector programmes. He has already received two extensions (the latest till August 2023) since he first took over in August 2019. Expect another extension, manning the position past the coming general election

BECAUSE he is the country's top-most serving bureaucrat and plays a pivotal role in overseeing the massive human resource capacity-building programme, Mission Karmayogi, to train public servants and upgrade their competencies

PAST MATTERS **As joint secretary in the Ministry of Environment & Forests, Gauba had worked with the then minister Jairam Ramesh of the Congress. He was a batchmate of BJP chief J.P. Nadda at Patna University**

BECAUSE along with R&AW chief Samanta Goel, he played a pivotal role in the abrogation of Article 370 of the Constitution along with the implementation of the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019, following which the state was divided into two Union Territories. Now preparations are on to conduct polls there

5 RAJIV GAUBA, 63

CABINET SECRETARY

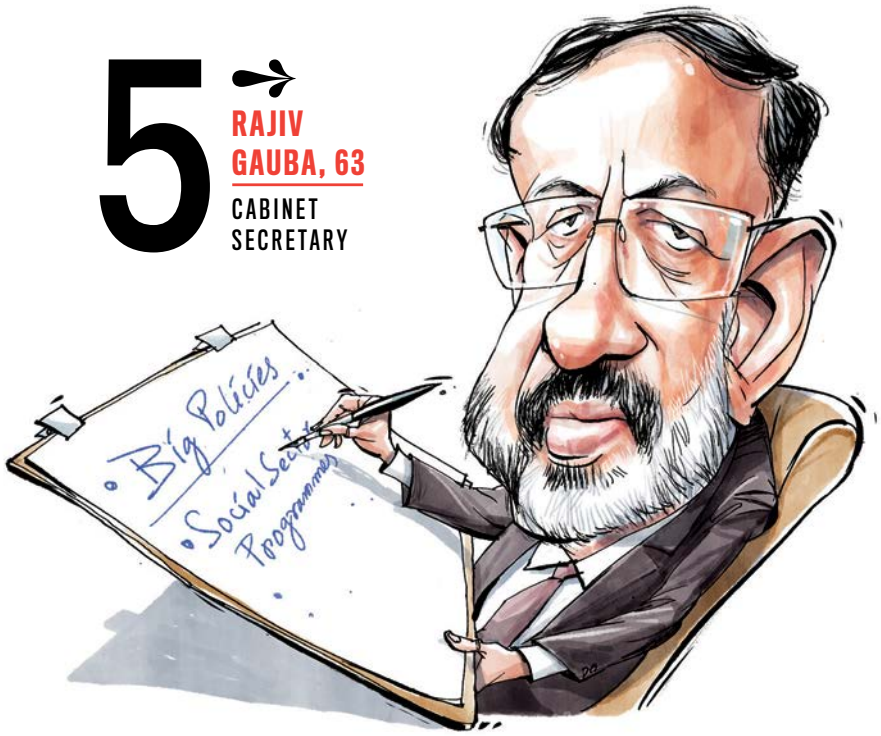


Illustration by ROUNAK PATRA



6 AJAY KUMAR BHALLA, 62

UNION HOME SECRETARY

7 S.K. MISHRA, 63

DIRECTOR, ENFORCEMENT DIRECTORATE

THE ENFORCER

BECAUSE the IRS officer heads the most-feared probing agency in the country, the Enforcement Directorate (ED). With the Supreme Court upholding all provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), the agency now has unfettered powers and is investigating some of the most high-profile cases in the country. Since 2005, when PMLA came into force, the ED has registered over 5,400 cases, more than 3,000 in the last five years. It has attached assets worth over Rs 1 lakh crore and Rs 23,000 crore have been deposited in public sector banks by selling assets of the accused

BECAUSE the ED has emerged as the agency that can change the